FREE CHECKLIST · November 2026

Technical SEO Audit Checklist

Actionable checks across 10 areas, from crawlability to hreflang, to make sure Google can crawl and index your site without friction.

8 sections · 48 checks

How to use this checklist

Work through the items in order and confirm each result with the method listed beside it. High priority marks issues that directly affect indexing or traffic, medium marks fixes that improve performance, and low marks fine-tuning.

Priority: **High** **Medium** **Low**

01 Crawlability

- [ ] **Confirm that robots.txt returns a 200 status code and does not block important sections.** High
  How: Open yourdomain.com/robots.txt; review fetch status and errors in the Search Console robots.txt report.
- [ ] **Make sure the CSS, JavaScript and image files needed to render pages are not blocked by robots.txt.** High
  How: Run "Test live URL" in the URL Inspection tool and check for page resources that could not be loaded.
- [ ] **Keep only canonical, indexable URLs that return 200 in your XML sitemap.** Medium
  How: Crawl the sitemap in list mode with a crawler (e.g. Screaming Frog); remove 3xx, 4xx, noindex and non-canonical URLs.
- [ ] **Submit the XML sitemap under Search Console > Sitemaps and confirm its status is "Success".** High
  How: Check the status and discovered URL count in the Sitemaps report; also add a Sitemap: line to robots.txt.
- [ ] **Find and fix internally linked pages that return 4xx and 5xx errors.** High
  How: Crawl the site and filter by status code; check responses in the Search Console Crawl Stats report.
- [ ] **Reduce redirect chains and loops to single-hop 301 redirects.** Medium
  How: Export the crawler's redirect chain report; point each chain straight at its final URL.
- [ ] **Confirm that non-existent pages return a real 404 or 410 code instead of 200.** Medium
  How: Open a random URL with browser dev tools; review the "Soft 404" row in the Page indexing report.
- [ ] **Use server logs to check that Googlebot is not spending crawl activity on parameterised or low-value URLs.** Low
  How: Filter the last 30 days of access logs by the Googlebot user agent; list the most-crawled URL patterns.

02 Indexing

- [ ] **Review the "Why pages aren't indexed" table in the Page indexing report reason by reason.** — High
  How: In the Page indexing report, open each reason, review sample URLs and click "Validate fix" once corrected.
- [ ] **Confirm that pages meant to be indexed carry no noindex in meta robots or the X-Robots-Tag header.** — High
  How: Filter the crawler's "Indexability" column; check HTTP response headers as well.
- [ ] **Give every indexable page a self-referencing canonical tag pointing to an absolute URL that returns 200.** — High
  How: In the crawler, filter pages whose canonical differs from their address or points to a non-200 URL.
- [ ] **Check that the Google-selected canonical matches your declared canonical on key pages.** — High
  How: Compare "User-declared canonical" and "Google-selected canonical" in the URL Inspection tool.
- [ ] **Do not block pages you want noindexed in robots.txt; otherwise Google cannot see the noindex tag.** — Medium
  How: Compare your list of noindex URLs against robots.txt rules; check them with a robots.txt tester.
- [ ] **Consolidate duplicate URLs created by filter, sort and tracking parameters into one version via canonicals or crawl rules.** — Medium
  How: Group URLs containing "?" and pages with identical titles in the crawler; check duplicate reasons in Page indexing.
- [ ] **Noindex or merge thin pages such as internal search results and empty tag pages.** — Low
  How: Sort pages by low word count in the crawler; flag those with no impressions in the Search Console Performance report.

03 Site structure, URLs and internal links

- [ ] **Use <a> tags with an href attribute for internal links; do not rely only on JavaScript click events.** — High
  How: Load the page with JavaScript disabled, or check the source to confirm menu and pagination links are <a href>.
- [ ] **Confirm that key pages are reachable within a few clicks of the homepage (ideally 3 or fewer).** — Medium
  How: Sort by the crawler's "Crawl Depth" column; link deep key pages from category or hub pages.
- [ ] **Find orphan pages that receive no internal links and link to them from relevant pages.** — Medium
  How: Compare sitemap and analytics URL lists with crawl results; URLs missing from the crawl are orphans.
- [ ] **Point internal links directly at final URLs rather than at redirecting addresses.** — Medium
  How: Export internal links that return 3xx in the crawler and update them on the source pages.
- [ ] **Keep URLs lowercase, hyphen-separated, readable and in a single version (www/non-www, trailing slash).** — Medium
  How: Open the different variants in a browser and check that each 301-redirects to one version.
- [ ] **Use anchor text that describes the target page instead of "click here".** — Low
  How: Export the crawler's internal anchor text report and filter for generic phrases.

04 Speed and Core Web Vitals

- [ ] **List "Poor" and "Needs improvement" URL groups for mobile and desktop in the Search Console Core Web Vitals report.** — High
  How: Open each issue in the Core Web Vitals report, test sample URLs in PageSpeed Insights and start validation after fixing.
- [ ] **Bring Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) to 2.5 seconds or less at the 75th percentile.** — High
  How: Check field (real-user) data in PageSpeed Insights; identify the LCP element in Lighthouse diagnostics.
- [ ] **Keep Interaction to Next Paint (INP) at 200 milliseconds or less.** — Medium
  How: Check INP in PageSpeed Insights field data; find long tasks in the Chrome DevTools Performance panel.
- [ ] **Keep Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS) at 0.1 or less.** — Medium
  How: Give images, video and ad slots width/height or fixed dimensions; track layout shifts in DevTools.
- [ ] **Serve images at the right size in modern formats (WebP/AVIF); do not lazy-load the LCP image.** — Medium
  How: Review Lighthouse image suggestions; check in the source that the LCP image has no loading="lazy".
- [ ] **Reduce server response time with caching, compression (Brotli/Gzip) and a CDN where needed.** — Low
  How: Check TTFB in PageSpeed Insights; inspect content-encoding and cache-control in response headers.

05 Mobile

- [ ] **Confirm the mobile version serves the same main content, headings, structured data and meta tags as desktop.** — High
  How: Google uses mobile-first indexing; crawl the same URLs with mobile and desktop user agents and compare the output.
- [ ] **Confirm every template includes the viewport meta tag.** — Medium
  How: Search the source for <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">.
- [ ] **Check for legible font sizes, adequate tap targets and no intrusive interstitials covering content on mobile.** — Medium
  How: Run Lighthouse accessibility and best-practice audits; browse the main templates on a real phone.
- [ ] **Confirm that content inside mobile tabs or accordions is present in the HTML without user interaction.** — Medium
  How: Use URL Inspection > Test live URL > View tested page and search the rendered HTML for the text.

06 Structured data

- [ ] **Add structured data in JSON-LD and confirm it has no critical errors.** — Medium
  How: Test a sample URL for each template in the Rich Results Test (search.google.com/test/rich-results).
- [ ] **Make sure every value in the markup (price, rating, date, author) matches the visible page content.** — High
  How: Compare the JSON-LD side by side with on-page text; check the Search Console Manual actions report.

- [ ] **Fix invalid items in the Search Console rich result reports and start validation.** Medium
  How: Open the report for your markup type in Search Console (e.g. Product snippets, Breadcrumbs) and review error rows.
- [ ] **Add Organization and WebSite markup (logo, sameAs, url) on the homepage.** Low
  How: Check the homepage with the Rich Results Test or the Schema Markup Validator (validator.schema.org).
- [ ] **You may keep FAQPage markup, but do not expect a click lift from it: Google has not shown FAQ rich results since 7 May 2026.** Low
  How: Re-evaluate work items that prioritise FAQ markup; shift effort to the quality of visible content.

07 HTTPS and security

- [ ] **Serve all pages over HTTPS and 301-redirect HTTP requests to HTTPS in a single hop.** High
  How: Test http:// homepage and inner page addresses with curl -I or a crawler.
- [ ] **Confirm that the Search Console Security issues and Manual actions reports are empty.** High
  How: Open both reports in Search Console; if an issue is listed, fix it and request a review.
- [ ] **Leave no mixed content (images, scripts, styles) loaded over HTTP on HTTPS pages.** Medium
  How: Look for mixed content warnings in the Chrome DevTools Console; filter http:// resources in the crawler.
- [ ] **Confirm the SSL/TLS certificate is valid and renews automatically.** Medium
  How: Check the expiry date via the browser padlock; confirm auto-renewal in your hosting panel.
- [ ] **Add the Strict-Transport-Security (HSTS) header once HTTPS is permanent.** Low
  How: Check for strict-transport-security in response headers with curl -I or the DevTools Network tab.

08 JavaScript rendering and international SEO

- [ ] **Confirm that main content and links appear in the HTML rendered by Google.** High
  How: In URL Inspection > Test live URL > View tested page > HTML tab, search for critical text and links.
- [ ] **Make sure title, meta robots and canonical tags do not conflict between the initial HTML and the JavaScript-rendered HTML.** High
  How: Compare view-source (Ctrl+U) with the rendered HTML; enable JavaScript rendering mode in your crawler.
- [ ] **Prefer server-side or static rendering for pages that drive search traffic.** Medium
  How: Load the page with JavaScript disabled; if main content is missing, review SSR/SSG options with developers.
- [ ] **Set up hreflang tags that are reciprocal, self-referencing and use valid ISO language/region codes (e.g. tr, en-GB).** Medium
  How: Filter missing return link and invalid code errors in your crawler's hreflang report.
- [ ] **Confirm that every URL referenced in hreflang returns 200 and is canonical.** Medium
  How: Crawl hreflang targets in list mode; fix those that redirect, are noindexed or carry a different canonical.
- [ ] **Add an x-default value for the language selector page or default version.** Low
  How: Search the source for an hreflang="x-default" line.

- [ ] **Offer a visible language switcher instead of automatically redirecting visitors by IP address or browser language.** Low
  How: Open the page with a different Accept-Language header or via VPN and check there is no forced redirect.

Detailed guides

Technical SEO guide
robots.txt guide
Crawled but not indexed pages
Core Web Vitals
JavaScript SEO
hreflang and international SEO
Schema and structured data guide

Need a second pair of eyes on your site? Book a free intro call:
fatihemincakiroglu.com/en/book-a-call

This checklist reflects publicly documented Google guidance as of November 2026. Search features change; check the official documentation before major decisions.